Personalized Meal Plan

by Diabetes and Endocrinology Centre

Consolidated Meal Plan

Meal Plan

Day	Breakfast	Lunch	Dinner	Snacks
Monday	Tofu and Vegetable Congee	Chinese Mapo Tofu with Steamed Bok Choy	Korean Spicy Braised Tofu (Dubu Jorim) with Steamed Broccoli	Roasted Edamame with Chili Flakes
Tuesday	Glutinous Rice Balls with Black Sesame (Tangyuan) and Berries	Korean Bibimbap with Tofu and Assorted Vegetables (No Egg, Cauliflower Rice)	Chinese Eggplant in Garlic Sauce with Shirataki Noodles	Air-Fried Seaweed Tofu Chips
Wednesday	Korean Soybean Sprout Soup with Tofu	Filipino Laing (Spicy Coconut Greens) with Grilled Mushrooms	Filipino Pinakbet (Vegetable Stew) with Crispy Air-Fried Tofu	Filipino Turon-Inspired Banana Rolls (Rice Paper, Air-Fried, No Sugar)
Thursday	Filipino Champorado with Coconut Milk and Chia Seeds	Chinese Stir-Fried Snow Peas and Tofu with Brown Rice	Korean Kimchi Stew with Silken Tofu and Zucchini	Chinese Five-Spice Roasted Chickpeas
Friday				
Saturday				
Sunday				

Recipes

Low-Carb Tofu and Vegetable Congee (East Asian Style, Vegetarian, Low Sodium)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 220 kcal
Protein: 14g
Carbs: 27g
Fat: 6g

Ingredients

- 75g (about 1/3 cup) short-grain brown rice, rinsed
- 400ml (1 2/3 cups) low-sodium vegetable broth (gluten-free, no added sugar)
- 400ml (1 2/3 cups) water
- 180g (6oz, about 1/2 block) firm tofu, pressed and cut into 1cm cubes
- 1/2 cup cauliflower florets, finely chopped
- 1/2 cup carrot, finely diced
- 1/2 cup baby spinach, chopped
- 1/2 cup shiitake mushrooms, thinly sliced (fresh or rehydrated dried)
- 2 teaspoons ginger, minced
- 2 teaspoons garlic, minced
- 1 tablespoon scallion (green onion), thinly sliced (white and green parts separated)
- 1 teaspoon low-sodium tamari (gluten-free soy sauce alternative, optional)
- 1/2 teaspoon toasted sesame oil
- White pepper to taste (optional)
- Fresh cilantro, chopped, for garnish (optional)
- Lemon or yuzu zest, for garnish (optional, adds brightness without sodium)

Instructions

1. Rinse the brown rice thoroughly under cold water until the water runs clear. This reduces surface starch and glycemic impact.
2. In the Instant Pot, add the rinsed rice, low-sodium vegetable broth, water, ginger, garlic, and the white part of the scallion.
3. Add the diced carrot, cauliflower, mushrooms, and tofu cubes. Stir gently to combine.
4. Close the lid and set the Instant Pot to 'Porridge' mode or Manual/Pressure Cook on high for 22 minutes.
5. Allow natural pressure release for 15 minutes, then carefully quick release any remaining pressure.
6. Open the lid, stir in the chopped spinach, and let the residual heat wilt the greens (about 2 minutes).
7. Add the low-sodium tamari (if using), toasted sesame oil, and a few shakes of white pepper if desired. Stir well, taste, and adjust seasoning if needed (avoid adding salt).
8. Ladle the congee into bowls. Garnish with the green part of the scallion, fresh cilantro, and a sprinkle of lemon or yuzu zest if desired.

Low-Carb Glutinous Rice Balls with Black Sesame & Berries (Tang Yuan Adaptation)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 125 kcal
Protein: 6g
Carbs: 8g
Fat: 8g

Ingredients

• 90g (3/4 cup) almond flour (ultra-fine, for low-carb dough)
• 30g (1/4 cup) coconut flour
• 30g (2 tbsp) unflavored plant protein powder (pea or soy isolate, unsweetened)
• 2 tbsp powdered erythritol (or other non-nutritive sweetener, to taste)
• 1/2 tsp glucomannan powder (or 1 tsp xanthan gum, binding agent)
• 80 ml (1/3 cup) hot water (approximate, for dough)
• 40g (4 tbsp) black sesame seeds
• 1 tbsp powdered erythritol (for sesame filling)
• 2 tsp avocado oil (or neutral vegetable oil)
• 1/2 tsp pure vanilla extract
• 60g (1/2 cup) fresh mixed berries (e.g., blueberries, raspberries, strawberries, chopped)
• 400 ml (1 2/3 cups) water (for cooking balls)

• Fresh mint leaves (optional, garnish)

Instructions

1. 1. Prepare Black Sesame Filling: In a dry skillet over low heat, gently toast black sesame seeds for 2-3 minutes until fragrant. Let cool, then blend in a blender until finely ground. Mix with 1 tbsp erythritol and 2 tsp avocado oil to form a thick, slightly moist paste. Stir in vanilla extract. Chill in fridge for 10-15 minutes.
2. 2. Make Low-Carb Dough: In a mixing bowl, combine almond flour, coconut flour, protein powder, 2 tbsp erythritol, and glucomannan powder. Gradually pour in hot water while stirring, until a soft, pliable dough forms (add more water by the teaspoon if too dry). Let rest for 5 minutes.
3. 3. Shape Balls: Divide dough into 8-10 equal pieces. With damp hands, flatten each piece into a small disc. Place a scant 1/2 tsp of black sesame paste in the center, wrap dough around filling, and roll gently to seal. Repeat with remaining dough and filling.
4. 4. Cook Rice Balls: Bring 400 ml water to a gentle simmer in an Instant Pot (using 'Saute') or on the stove. Carefully add balls; simmer uncovered for 6-8 minutes or until they float. Remove with a slotted spoon.
5. 5. Serve: Divide balls among serving bowls. Top each with 1-2 tbsp fresh mixed berries and a sprig of mint if desired. Serve warm or at room temperature. (Optional: drizzle with a little berry puree for extra flavor—blend 2 tbsp berries with a touch of sweetener and 1 tsp water.)

Korean Soybean Sprout Soup with Tofu (Kongnamul-guk - Vegetarian, Low Sodium, Low Carb)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 110 kcal
Protein: 11g
Carbs: 9g
Fat: 4g

Ingredients

• 300g (about 6 cups) fresh soybean sprouts, washed and roots trimmed
• 200g (7 oz) firm tofu, cut into 1 cm cubes
• 1.2 liters (5 cups) filtered water
• 1/2 medium yellow onion, thinly sliced
• 2 garlic cloves, minced
• 1 small zucchini, cut into thin half-moons (about 80g)

- 2 green onions, chopped (white and green parts separated)
- 1 small carrot, julienned (about 40g)
- 1 tbsp low sodium tamari (gluten-free soy sauce alternative)
- 1 tsp toasted sesame oil
- 1/4 tsp freshly ground black pepper
- 1 dried kelp sheet (kombu), 5 x 5 cm (optional for more umami)
- 1 small piece fresh red chili, thinly sliced (optional, for flavor—not for spice)
- 1/2 tsp toasted sesame seeds (optional, for garnish)

Instructions

1. Prepare all vegetables: Wash and trim soybean sprouts. Slice onion and zucchini, julienne carrot, mince garlic, and chop green onion (keep white and green parts separate). Cut tofu into 1 cm cubes.
2. In the Instant Pot (or a large pot), combine water, dried kelp, onion, minced garlic, and white parts of green onion. Set to 'Sauté' mode and bring to a gentle simmer for 5 minutes to extract flavor from the kelp (remove kelp after 5 minutes for best taste).
3. Add soybean sprouts, zucchini, carrot, and tofu cubes to the pot. Stir gently.
4. Add low sodium tamari and black pepper. Stir. (Do not add salt or additional sodium sources.)
5. Secure the Instant Pot lid, set to 'Soup/Broth' mode or manual high pressure for 5 minutes. If using stovetop: Bring to a gentle boil, then reduce heat and simmer uncovered for 10 minutes.
6. Perform a quick release (if using Instant Pot). Open, then drizzle in toasted sesame oil. Add green parts of green onion and sliced chili (if using). Stir gently.
7. Taste and adjust pepper or sesame oil if desired. Serve hot, garnished with optional toasted sesame seeds and extra green onions.

Low-Carb Filipino Champorado with Coconut Milk & Chia Seeds

Nutritional Information

Calories: 185 kcal
Protein: 6g
Carbs: 12g
Fat: 11g

Ingredients

• 1/2 cup black chia seeds
• 2 1/2 cups unsweetened light coconut milk (carton, not canned for lower fat and calories)
• 1 1/2 cups water
• 2 tbsp unsweetened cocoa powder (preferably Dutch-processed)
• 1/2 tsp vanilla extract
• 1/4 tsp salt substitute (potassium-based, optional and only if cleared by healthcare provider; otherwise omit)
• 2 tbsp monk fruit sweetener (or stevia, erythritol blend, adjust to taste)
• 1/4 cup unsweetened shredded coconut (for topping, optional)
• 2 tbsp roasted unsalted pumpkin seeds (pepitas, for topping, optional)

Instructions

1. In the Instant Pot (or a medium saucepan if cooking stovetop), combine chia seeds, 2 cups of coconut milk, 1 1/2 cups water, cocoa powder, vanilla extract, and sweetener.
2. Whisk well to combine, making sure the cocoa powder is fully dissolved.
3. Seal the Instant Pot lid and set to 'Porridge' or 'Manual' setting for 2 minutes. Let the pressure naturally release for 10 minutes, then quick release any remaining pressure. (If using stovetop: bring mixture to a gentle simmer, whisking often for about 5-7 minutes until thick and chia seeds have expanded.)
4. Open the lid and stir well. If the champorado is too thick, add the remaining 1/2 cup coconut milk and mix until you reach desired consistency.
5. Taste and adjust sweetness as needed. Let cool for 5 minutes to further thicken.
6. Spoon into bowls and top with a sprinkle of unsweetened shredded coconut and pumpkin seeds for extra protein and texture.
7. Serve warm or chilled.

Vegetarian Mapo Tofu with Steamed Bok Choy (Low Sodium, Low Carb, Gluten-Free)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 230 kcal
Protein: 17g
Carbs: 12g
Fat: 13g

Ingredients

- 400g (14 oz) firm or medium-firm tofu, cut into 2 cm cubes
- 150g (5 oz) bok choy, halved or quartered lengthwise
- 100g (3.5 oz) shiitake mushrooms, finely chopped
- 2 tablespoons avocado oil or canola oil (neutral, heart-healthy)
- 2 cloves garlic, minced
- 1 tablespoon fresh ginger, minced
- 2 scallions, whites and greens separated, finely sliced
- 1.5 tablespoons low-sodium gluten-free tamari or coconut aminos
- 1 tablespoon Sichuan peppercorns, lightly crushed (optional, for authentic flavor)
- 1 tablespoon chili bean paste (doubanjiang), reduced-sodium or homemade low-sodium version (see Tips)
- 1 tablespoon tomato paste (unsalted)
- 1 teaspoon chili flakes (Korean gochugaru or Chinese chili flakes, optional for heat)
- 1 teaspoon toasted sesame oil
- 1.5 teaspoons cornstarch, mixed with 2 tablespoons water
- 1/2 cup low-sodium, MSG-free vegetable broth
- Fresh cilantro or extra scallion greens for garnish (optional)

Instructions

1. 1. Prepare all ingredients: Cut tofu into 2 cm cubes. Rinse and halve (or quarter) bok choy. Chop mushrooms, garlic, ginger, and scallions.
2. 2. In your Instant Pot (or a nonstick pan if preferred), heat 1 tablespoon oil on sauté mode (or medium heat). Add garlic, ginger, and scallion whites. Sauté for 1 minute until fragrant.
3. 3. Add chopped mushrooms and cook for 2-3 minutes until softened.
4. 4. Stir in chili bean paste, tomato paste, and (if using) chili flakes and Sichuan peppercorns. Sauté 1 more minute.
5. 5. Add tofu cubes, gently folding to coat in the aromatics.
6. 6. Pour in tamari (or coconut aminos) and vegetable broth. Simmer gently for 4-5 minutes (on low sauté or low heat), allowing flavors to meld.
7. 7. Mix cornstarch with water. Stir this slurry into the pot to thicken the sauce. Cook for 1-2 more minutes until glossy. Drizzle with toasted sesame oil. Turn off heat and gently fold in half of the scallion greens.
8. 8. While the Mapo Tofu simmers, steam bok choy: Place bok choy in a microwave-safe bowl with 2 tablespoons water. Cover and microwave on high for 2-3 minutes until just tender. Drain and set aside.
9. 9. Serve Mapo Tofu hot, garnished with remaining scallion greens and optional cilantro, alongside steamed bok choy.

Low-Carb Korean Bibimbap with Tofu and Assorted Vegetables (Vegetarian, Low Sodium, Gluten-Free)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 320 kcal
Protein: 23g
Carbs: 15g
Fat: 16g

Ingredients

• 200g firm tofu (pressed, drained, cut into 1cm cubes)
• 1 tablespoon avocado oil (or canola oil, divided)
• 1 cup shirataki rice (rinsed and drained, or cooked cauliflower rice)
• 1/2 cup bean sprouts (blanched)
• 1/2 cup zucchini (julienned)
• 1/2 cup carrots (julienned)
• 1/2 cup shiitake mushrooms (fresh, sliced)
• 1/2 cup spinach (fresh, blanched, squeezed dry)
• 1/4 cup red bell pepper (julienned)
• 1 teaspoon toasted sesame oil
• 1 teaspoon sesame seeds (toasted, optional)
• 1 green onion (thinly sliced, green part only)
• 1 clove garlic (finely minced, divided)
• 1/2 teaspoon ginger (fresh, minced)
• 1 tablespoon low sodium tamari (gluten-free, or coconut aminos)
• 1 tablespoon gochujang (Korean chili paste, gluten-free, low sodium if available, or use 1 tsp chili flakes + 1 tsp tomato paste for ultra-low sodium version)
• 1 teaspoon rice vinegar
• 1/2 teaspoon monk fruit sweetener (or erythritol, optional)
• Fresh ground black pepper to taste

Instructions

1. Prepare the tofu: Pat tofu cubes dry. In the Air Fryer, spray or brush 1/2 tablespoon avocado oil on tofu. Air fry at 200°C (400°F) for 10-12 minutes, shaking halfway, until golden and crisp. Alternatively, pan-fry in a nonstick pan over medium heat with 1/2 tablespoon oil until golden.
2. Prepare the vegetables: Blanch bean sprouts and spinach in boiling water for 1 minute each, then rinse under cold water. Squeeze spinach dry and mix with half the garlic and 1/4 teaspoon sesame oil.
3. Stir-fry zucchini, carrots, mushrooms, and bell pepper separately: Heat a nonstick pan over medium heat, add a splash of oil if needed, and cook each vegetable for 2-3 minutes until tender-crisp. Season lightly with black pepper. Set aside.
4. Prepare the base: Rinse and drain shirataki rice or prepare cauliflower rice according to package instructions (microwave or sauté for 2-3 minutes). Place as the base in a wide bowl.
5. Make the sauce: In a small bowl, whisk together gochujang (or chili/tomato paste mix), rice vinegar, monk fruit sweetener, remaining garlic, and 1 tablespoon low sodium tamari or coconut aminos. Thin with water if needed for drizzling consistency.
6. Assemble: Arrange tofu and vegetables over the rice base in sections. Drizzle with the prepared sauce. Garnish with green onion, toasted sesame seeds, and a light drizzle of sesame oil.
7. Serve immediately and mix at the table before eating.

Filipino Laing with Grilled Mushrooms (Vegetarian, Low Sodium, Low Carb)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 220 kcal
Protein: 14g
Carbs: 14g
Fat: 12g

Ingredients

• 200g dried taro leaves (soaked and rinsed in cold water to remove oxalates)
• 1 tablespoon avocado oil (or olive oil)
• 1 medium red onion, finely chopped (about 100g)
• 3 cloves garlic, minced
• 1 thumb-sized piece ginger, peeled and minced (about 15g)
• 1-2 pieces siling labuyo (bird's eye chili), chopped (optional, adjust to taste)
• 1 large red bell pepper, julienned (about 120g)
• 1 cup canned lite coconut milk (unsweetened, low sodium if available)

• 1/2 cup water
• 200g firm tofu, pressed and cut into cubes
• 250g fresh oyster mushrooms (or shiitake or king oyster), cleaned and thickly sliced
• 1 tablespoon coconut aminos (as a low-sodium soy sauce alternative)
• 1 tablespoon fresh calamansi or lime juice
• 1/4 teaspoon ground black pepper
• 2 scallions, finely chopped (for garnish)
• 1 tablespoon chopped fresh cilantro (for garnish, optional)

Instructions

1. 1. Prepare the mushrooms: Toss the sliced mushrooms with 1 teaspoon avocado oil, a pinch of black pepper, and 1 teaspoon coconut aminos. Air fry at 200°C (400°F) for 8-10 minutes or until golden and lightly crisp. Set aside.
2. 2. In an Instant Pot (or large nonstick pan), heat 2 teaspoons avocado oil on sauté mode. Add red onion, garlic, and ginger. Sauté for 3-4 minutes until fragrant and translucent.
3. 3. Add the bell pepper and optional chili. Sauté for 2 more minutes.
4. 4. Stir in the tofu cubes and sauté for another 2-3 minutes to lightly brown.
5. 5. Add the rinsed and drained taro leaves to the pot. Pour in the coconut milk, water, and remaining coconut aminos. Gently press down the leaves so they're submerged.
6. 6. Set the Instant Pot to 'Slow Cook' mode (or continue on the stovetop on low heat). Cover and cook for 35-40 minutes, stirring occasionally, until the taro leaves are completely tender and the mixture is thickened.
7. 7. Taste and adjust seasoning with calamansi/lime juice and extra black pepper if needed.
8. 8. To serve: Plate the creamy laing mixture and top with the grilled mushrooms. Garnish with chopped scallions and fresh cilantro.
9. 9. Serve hot. Enjoy with a side of steamed cauliflower rice for a complete low-carb Filipino meal (optional, not included in nutrition calculation).

Chinese Stir-Fried Snow Peas and Tofu with Brown Rice (Low Sodium, Vegetarian, Gluten-Free, Low Carb)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 320 kcal
Protein: 17g
Carbs: 32g

Fat: 12g

Ingredients

- Firm tofu, drained and pressed – 200g (about 7oz)
- Snow peas, washed, trimmed – 120g (about 1 cup)
- Red bell pepper, thinly sliced – 50g (about 1/2 cup)
- Shiitake mushrooms, sliced – 50g (about 1/2 cup)
- Brown rice (uncooked) – 60g (about 1/4 cup, yields ~3/4 cup cooked)
- Avocado oil or canola oil – 2 teaspoons
- Fresh ginger, minced – 1 teaspoon
- Garlic, minced – 1 teaspoon
- Low sodium, gluten-free tamari or coconut aminos – 2 teaspoons
- Rice vinegar (unsweetened) – 1 teaspoon
- Toasted sesame oil – 1/2 teaspoon
- Spring onion, chopped – 1 tablespoon (for garnish)
- Sesame seeds, toasted – 1/2 teaspoon (optional, for garnish)
- Fresh ground black pepper – to taste

Instructions

1. Prepare the brown rice: Rinse 60g uncooked brown rice thoroughly. Using the Instant Pot, add the rice and 160ml (about 2/3 cup) water. Cook on 'Rice' or 'Manual' function for 22 minutes, natural pressure release for 10 minutes. Fluff and set aside.
2. While rice cooks, cut tofu into 1-inch cubes. Pat dry further with kitchen paper for better texture.
3. Optional (for firmer tofu): Air fry tofu cubes at 200°C (400°F) for 10-12 minutes, shaking basket halfway, until lightly golden.
4. Heat 2 teaspoons avocado oil in a large nonstick skillet or wok over medium-high heat.
5. Add the ginger and garlic. Stir-fry for 30 seconds until fragrant.
6. Add the mushrooms and red bell pepper. Stir-fry for 2 minutes.
7. Add snow peas and cook another 2 minutes, until bright green but still crisp.
8. Add tofu cubes and gently toss to combine.
9. Drizzle with 2 teaspoons low-sodium tamari (or coconut aminos), 1 teaspoon rice vinegar, and 1/2 teaspoon toasted sesame oil. Stir-fry for 1 more minute to heat through.
10. Season with fresh ground black pepper to taste. Remove from heat.
11. Serve stir-fry over 3/4 cup cooked brown rice. Garnish with chopped spring onion and sesame seeds if desired.

Korean Spicy Braised Tofu with Steamed Broccoli (Vegetarian, Low Carb, Low Sodium, Gluten-Free)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 232 kcal
Protein: 18g
Carbs: 10g
Fat: 13g

Ingredients

• 400g (14 oz) extra-firm tofu, pressed and cut into 1/2-inch thick rectangles
• 2 cups (150g) broccoli florets
• 1 tablespoon cold-pressed canola or avocado oil
• 2 cloves garlic, minced
• 1 teaspoon ginger, grated
• 2 tablespoons low-sodium gluten-free tamari (or coconut aminos for lower sodium)
• 1 tablespoon gochugaru (Korean red chili flakes, or 1 tsp for less heat)
• 1 teaspoon toasted sesame oil
• 1 tablespoon rice vinegar (unseasoned, no sugar/salt added)
• 1 teaspoon monk fruit or stevia sweetener (granulated, optional for balance)
• 1/4 cup filtered water
• 1 stalk green onion, thinly sliced (for garnish)
• 1 teaspoon toasted sesame seeds (optional, for garnish)
• Freshly ground black pepper, to taste

Instructions

1. Prepare Tofu: Press tofu for at least 10 minutes to remove excess water. Cut into 1/2-inch thick rectangles or squares.
2. Make Sauce: In a small bowl, whisk together low-sodium tamari (or coconut aminos), gochugaru, rice vinegar, monk fruit or stevia sweetener, 1/4 cup water, and toasted sesame oil. Set aside.
3. Sear Tofu: Heat canola or avocado oil in a nonstick skillet or use the Instant Pot on 'Sauté' mode. Add tofu pieces in a single layer. Cook 3-4 minutes per side until lightly golden. Remove and set aside.

4. Aromatics: In the same pan, add garlic and ginger. Stir-fry for 30 seconds until fragrant.
5. Braise Tofu: Return tofu to the pan. Pour in the sauce. Gently toss tofu to coat. Lower heat, cover, and simmer for 6-8 minutes, flipping halfway, until sauce thickens and tofu is well glazed.
6. Steam Broccoli: While tofu braises, steam broccoli florets in the microwave (in a microwave-safe bowl with 2 tbsp water, covered, 2-3 minutes) or in the Instant Pot (steam basket, 1 cup water, 0 minutes high pressure, quick release). Broccoli should be bright green and tender-crisp.
7. Serve: Plate steamed broccoli beside or beneath the braised tofu. Spoon extra sauce over tofu. Garnish with green onions, sesame seeds (if using), and a pinch of black pepper.
8. Enjoy immediately. Leftovers keep well in the fridge up to 3 days.

Chinese Eggplant in Garlic Sauce with Shirataki Noodles

Nutritional Information

Calories: 220 kcal
Protein: 15g
Carbs: 18g (net carbs ~10g, due to high fiber in Shirataki noodles and eggplant)
Fat: 10g

Ingredients

• 2 medium Chinese eggplants (~400g), cut into 1-inch batons
• 2 packs (200g total, drained) Shirataki noodles
• 1/2 block (175g) extra-firm tofu, pressed and cut into 1/2-inch cubes
• 2 cups broccoli florets
• 2 tablespoons avocado oil (or canola oil)
• 4 cloves garlic, minced
• 1 tablespoon fresh ginger, minced
• 2 scallions, chopped (separate white and green parts)
• 1/4 cup low-sodium tamari (gluten-free soy sauce alternative)
• 1 tablespoon rice vinegar (unsweetened)
• 1 tablespoon Shaoxing wine (optional, or use more rice vinegar)
• 1 tablespoon erythritol or monk fruit sweetener (granulated, optional)

• 1 tablespoon cornstarch or arrowroot starch (gluten-free), mixed with 2 tablespoons water
• 1/2 teaspoon toasted sesame oil
• 1/4 teaspoon ground white pepper
• 1/4 teaspoon crushed red pepper flakes (optional, adjust to taste)
• Fresh cilantro or basil, for garnish (optional)

Instructions

1. Prepare Shirataki noodles: Drain, rinse well under cold water, and microwave for 1-2 minutes or dry-fry in a nonstick pan for 2-3 minutes to remove odor and excess moisture. Set aside.
2. Air fry (preferred for less oil) or pan-sear tofu: Toss tofu cubes lightly with 1 teaspoon avocado oil. Air fry at 400°F (200°C) for 12 minutes, shaking halfway, until golden. Alternatively, pan-sear in a nonstick skillet until golden on all sides. Set aside.
3. Air fry eggplant: Toss eggplant with 1 tablespoon oil. Air fry at 400°F (200°C) for 10-12 minutes until browned and tender, shaking halfway. (Or, stir-fry in a nonstick pan over medium-high heat for 5-7 minutes.) Set aside.
4. Steam broccoli florets in the microwave with 2 tablespoons water for 2 minutes until bright green and crisp-tender. Drain and set aside.
5. Make garlic sauce: In a small bowl, mix low-sodium tamari, rice vinegar, Shaoxing wine (if using), erythritol, sesame oil, white pepper, and red pepper flakes. Set aside.
6. In the Instant Pot (on sauté mode) or a large nonstick skillet, heat remaining 2 teaspoons avocado oil. Sauté garlic, ginger, and white parts of scallion until fragrant (about 1 minute).
7. Add cooked eggplant and tofu, and pour in the garlic sauce. Stir gently to coat.
8. Mix in the cornstarch slurry. Stir and cook for 1-2 minutes, until the sauce thickens and coats the vegetables.
9. Add steamed broccoli and Shirataki noodles. Toss well to combine and heat through.
10. Garnish with green scallion tops and fresh herbs if desired. Serve immediately.

Filipino Pinakbet with Crispy Air-Fried Tofu (Vegetarian, Low Sodium, Low Carb, Gluten-Free)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 220 kcal
Protein: 14g
Carbs: 19g
Fat: 9g

Ingredients

- 350g firm tofu, drained and pressed
- 1 tablespoon olive oil (divided: ½ tbsp for tofu, ½ tbsp for sautéing)
- 1 small eggplant (about 120g), cut into 1-inch cubes
- 1 cup bitter melon (ampalaya), sliced thinly
- 1 cup kabocha squash (kalabasa), peeled and cut into 1-inch cubes
- 1 cup string beans (sitaw), cut into 2-inch lengths
- 1 small zucchini (about 100g), sliced
- 1/2 cup cherry tomatoes, halved
- 1 small red onion, sliced
- 3 cloves garlic, minced
- 1 tablespoon low-sodium tamari (gluten-free soy sauce alternative)
- 1 tablespoon Filipino miso (yellow/white miso, low sodium if available)
- 1/2 cup water
- 1/4 teaspoon freshly ground black pepper
- 1/4 teaspoon turmeric powder (optional, for added anti-inflammatory benefit)
- 1 tablespoon fresh ginger, sliced
- 1 tablespoon apple cider vinegar
- Fresh cilantro or scallion, chopped, for garnish (optional)

Instructions

1. Prepare the tofu: Cut the pressed tofu into 1-inch cubes. Toss gently with ½ tablespoon olive oil and a pinch of black pepper.
2. Air-fry tofu: Arrange tofu cubes in a single layer in the air fryer basket. Air fry at 200°C (392°F) for 12-15 minutes, shaking halfway, until golden and crisp. Set aside.
3. Prep the vegetables: While tofu is cooking, wash and chop all vegetables as described.
4. Make the Pinakbet base: In a large non-stick skillet or Instant Pot on sauté mode, heat the remaining ½ tablespoon olive oil over medium heat. Add onion, garlic, and ginger. Sauté for 2-3 minutes until fragrant and translucent.
5. Add the kabocha squash and eggplant. Sauté for another 3-4 minutes.
6. Add miso, tamari, turmeric (if using), and water. Stir to dissolve miso. Add in bitter melon, string beans, zucchini, and cherry tomatoes.
7. Pour in apple cider vinegar. Cover and simmer gently for 8-10 minutes on low heat, until vegetables are just tender. Stir occasionally and add a splash more water if needed to prevent sticking. Do not overcook to preserve nutrients and texture.
8. Taste and adjust seasoning (avoid adding more salt or soy sauce to maintain low sodium).
9. To serve: Transfer cooked vegetables to a serving dish. Top with crispy air-fried tofu. Garnish with chopped cilantro or scallion if desired.

Korean Kimchi Stew with Silken Tofu and Zucchini (Vegetarian, Low Sodium, Low Carb, Gluten-Free)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 170 kcal
Protein: 13g
Carbs: 10g
Fat: 8g

Ingredients

• 200g low-sodium, vegan kimchi (ensure no fish sauce or shrimp, rinse if needed)
• 1 medium zucchini (about 170g), sliced into half-moons
• 200g silken tofu, cut into large cubes
• 1/2 cup oyster mushrooms, torn into bite-size pieces
• 1/2 cup firm or extra-firm tofu, cubed (for added protein; optional but recommended)
• 1/2 small onion (about 50g), thinly sliced
• 2 cloves garlic, minced
• 1 teaspoon ginger, minced
• 2 teaspoons low-sodium, gluten-free tamari or coconut aminos
• 1 tablespoon gochugaru (Korean red chili flakes, adjust to taste, optional for spice)
• 1 teaspoon toasted sesame oil
• 2 cups low-sodium vegetable broth (homemade or unsalted store-bought)
• 1/2 teaspoon ground white pepper (optional)
• 2 scallions, chopped (for garnish)
• 1 teaspoon roasted sesame seeds (for garnish, optional)

Instructions

1. Prepare all vegetables: slice zucchini into half-moons, onions thinly, and mushrooms into bite-size pieces. Cube both silken and firm tofu.
2. If store-bought kimchi is not low-sodium, place it in a fine mesh sieve and rinse briefly under cold water to remove excess salt and brine. Drain well and chop into bite-size pieces.

3. Set Instant Pot to 'Sauté' mode (or use a stovetop pot if preferred). Add sesame oil, onions, garlic, and ginger. Sauté for 2-3 minutes until fragrant, but do not brown.
4. Add mushrooms and zucchini. Sauté for another 1-2 minutes. Stir in the chopped kimchi and gochugaru (if using), and cook for 2 more minutes.
5. Pour in the low-sodium vegetable broth and tamari/coconut aminos. Stir well, scraping up any bits from the bottom.
6. Add both types of tofu (silken and firm). Gently stir to combine, being careful not to break the silken tofu.
7. Cancel 'Sauté' mode. Secure Instant Pot lid and set to 'Manual' or 'Pressure Cook' on LOW for 2 minutes. (Alternatively, simmer on stovetop for 10 minutes, uncovered.)
8. Quick-release pressure if using Instant Pot. Open lid and gently stir. Taste and adjust seasoning as needed (add more pepper or tamari if desired, but minimize sodium).
9. Ladle into bowls. Garnish with chopped scallions and a sprinkle of sesame seeds.
10. Serve hot as a main dish, optionally with a small side of steamed cauliflower rice for extra fiber and minimal carbs.

East Asian Roasted Edamame with Chili Flakes

Nutritional Information

Calories: 160 kcal
Protein: 14 g
Carbs: 12 g
Fat: 7 g

Ingredients

• 2 cups frozen shelled edamame (unsalted, thawed)
• 1.5 teaspoons toasted sesame oil (cold-pressed, sodium-free)
• 1/2 teaspoon Korean gochugaru (Korean chili flakes) or Chinese chili flakes
• 1/4 teaspoon garlic powder
• 1/8 teaspoon freshly ground black pepper
• 1/2 teaspoon roasted sesame seeds (optional, for garnish)
• 1 green onion, finely sliced (optional, for garnish)

Instructions

1. Preheat your air fryer to 400°F (200°C) for 3 minutes.
2. Pat the thawed edamame dry with a paper towel to remove excess moisture (this helps them roast better and get crisp).
3. In a large bowl, toss the edamame with sesame oil, gochugaru or chili flakes, garlic powder, and black pepper until evenly coated.
4. Spread the seasoned edamame in a single layer in the air fryer basket.
5. Air fry at 400°F (200°C) for 10-12 minutes, shaking the basket halfway through, until the edamame are lightly browned and crisp at the edges.
6. Transfer to a serving bowl. Sprinkle with sesame seeds and green onion, if using.
7. Serve warm or at room temperature as a high-protein, diabetes-friendly snack or side.

Air-Fried Seaweed Tofu Chips (East Asian Style, Vegetarian, Low Carb, Low Sodium)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 140 kcal
Protein: 12g
Carbs: 5g
Fat: 7g

Ingredients

• Extra-firm tofu, 400g (drained and pressed)
• Roasted unsalted nori seaweed sheets, 4 full sheets
• Sesame oil (cold-pressed, optional), 1 teaspoon
• Low-sodium gluten-free soy sauce (tamari), 1 teaspoon
• Rice vinegar, 1 teaspoon
• Toasted sesame seeds, 1 teaspoon
• Garlic powder, 1/4 teaspoon
• Freshly ground black pepper, 1/8 teaspoon
• Green onions, finely sliced, 1 tablespoon (optional, for garnish)

Instructions

1. 1. Prepare the tofu: Drain the tofu and press it for at least 20 minutes to remove excess water. Pat dry. Slice into thin rectangles or squares, about 1/4-inch thick.
2. 2. Cut the nori sheets: Cut each nori sheet into pieces that match the size of your tofu slices.
3. 3. Mix marinade: In a small bowl, whisk together the sesame oil, low-sodium tamari, rice vinegar, garlic powder, and black pepper.
4. 4. Marinate: Gently brush both sides of each tofu slice with the marinade. Let sit for 10–15 minutes to absorb flavors.
5. 5. Assemble: Place a piece of nori on top of each tofu slice. Gently press so it adheres. (Optional: lightly brush the nori side with a bit more marinade to help it stick.)
6. 6. Preheat the air fryer to 180°C (350°F) for 3 minutes.
7. 7. Arrange tofu chips in a single layer (nori side up) in the air fryer basket. Do not overcrowd; cook in batches if needed.
8. 8. Air fry for 10–13 minutes, flipping halfway, until tofu is crisp and golden and nori is crunchy but not burnt. Adjust time as needed based on your air fryer.
9. 9. Remove chips and immediately sprinkle with toasted sesame seeds. Let cool slightly; garnish with green onions if desired.
10. 10. Serve warm or at room temperature. Store leftovers in an airtight container for up to 2 days.

Filipino Turon-Inspired Banana Rolls (Low-Carb, Vegetarian, Gluten-Free, Air Fryer)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 120 kcal
Protein: 5g
Carbs: 13g (net: 9g, fiber: 4g)
Fat: 5g

Ingredients

• 2 small ripe saba bananas or 1 large ripe plantain (about 200g total)
• 4 gluten-free, low-carb coconut wraps (e.g., Nuco brand) or similar, 20cm x 20cm each
• 2 tablespoons unsweetened shredded coconut
• 1 tablespoon plant-based vanilla protein powder (unsweetened, stevia or monk fruit sweetened)
• 1 tablespoon erythritol or monk fruit sweetener (granulated, optional for extra sweetness)
• 1 teaspoon ground cinnamon
• 1/4 teaspoon vanilla extract (alcohol-free preferred)
• Avocado oil spray (for air fryer)

• Optional: 1 tablespoon chopped roasted peanuts (unsalted, for garnish)

Instructions

1. Peel the saba bananas or plantain. Slice each lengthwise into 2-4 thin strips, aiming for about 4 total pieces.
2. In a small bowl, mix together the shredded coconut, protein powder, erythritol/monk fruit sweetener, cinnamon, and vanilla extract.
3. Lay one coconut wrap flat on a clean surface. Place 1/4 of the banana slices near one edge of the wrap. Sprinkle 1/4 of the coconut-protein mixture over the banana.
4. Fold in the sides and roll up tightly, sealing the edge with a dab of water if needed. Repeat for the remaining wraps and filling.
5. Lightly spray the outside of each roll with avocado oil spray.
6. Preheat the air fryer to 350°F (175°C) for 2 minutes.
7. Arrange the rolls seam-side down in the air fryer basket in a single layer. Air fry for 5-7 minutes, turning once halfway, until the wraps are golden and crisp.
8. Let cool slightly before serving. Optionally, sprinkle with chopped roasted peanuts before serving.

Chinese Five-Spice Roasted Chickpeas (Air Fryer, Low Sodium, Diabetic-Friendly)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 120 kcal
Protein: 6g
Carbs: 16g (net carbs: 13g, fiber: 3g)
Fat: 4g

Ingredients

• 1 (15 oz / 425g) can no-salt-added chickpeas (garbanzo beans), drained and rinsed
• 1 tablespoon avocado oil (or cold-pressed canola oil; both are heart-healthy, neutral-flavored, and low in saturated fat)
• 3/4 teaspoon Chinese five-spice powder (salt-free, see tip below)
• 1/4 teaspoon garlic powder
• 1/4 teaspoon onion powder
• 1/8 teaspoon ground white pepper
• 1/2 teaspoon toasted sesame seeds (optional, for garnish)

• 1 teaspoon low-sodium tamari or coconut aminos (gluten-free, optional for umami; choose coconut aminos for very low sodium)

Instructions

1. Preheat the air fryer to 375°F (190°C) for 3 minutes.
2. Pat the chickpeas dry thoroughly with paper towels or a clean kitchen towel—removing as much surface moisture as possible for maximum crispness.
3. In a mixing bowl, toss the chickpeas with avocado oil, Chinese five-spice powder, garlic powder, onion powder, and white pepper. If using, add the low-sodium tamari or coconut aminos for extra umami (note: coconut aminos is lower in sodium). Stir until chickpeas are evenly coated.
4. Spread the chickpeas in a single layer in the air fryer basket.
5. Air fry for 12–15 minutes, shaking the basket every 5 minutes to ensure even cooking. Chickpeas should be golden and crispy, but not burnt. (Watch closely after 12 minutes.)
6. Transfer to a serving bowl, sprinkle with optional toasted sesame seeds, and allow to cool slightly—chickpeas will continue to crisp as they cool.
7. Serve warm or at room temperature as a snack, salad topper, or protein-rich side.

Shopping List

Refrigerated / Plant Protein

- Firm or Extra-Firm Tofu - 2.5 kg
- Silken Tofu - 200 g

Produce

- Soybean Sprouts - 1 lb (454 g) bag
- Cauliflower - 1 head (≈1.5 lb)
- Carrots - 2 lb
- Baby Spinach - 1 × 454 g (1 lb) bag
- Shiitake Mushrooms - 350 g
- Oyster Mushrooms (or King Oyster) - 1 × 250 g pack
- Snow Peas - 120 g
- Broccoli Florets - 2 lb
- Zucchini - 3 pieces (≈1.5 lb)
- Red Bell Peppers - 3 pieces (≈1.5 lb)
- Green Onions / Scallions - 2 bunches
- Onions (Yellow or Red) - 2 lb
- Garlic Bulbs - 4 bulbs
- Ginger Root - 0.5 lb
- Cherry Tomatoes - 0.5 lb
- Kabocha Squash - 1 small squash (≈1.5 lb)
- String Beans (Sitaw) - 1 lb
- Bitter Melon (Ampalaya) - 1 piece (≈1/2 lb)
- Eggplant (Chinese & Regular) - 3 pieces (≈2 lb)
- Zucchini - 3 pieces (≈1.5 lb)
- Red Onion - 2 pieces (≈1 lb)
- Fresh Mixed Berries (Blueberries, Raspberries, etc.) - 0.5 lb (≈225 g)

- Siling Labuyo (Bird's Eye Chili) or Red Chili - 0.25 lb
- Fresh Calamansi or Limes - 2 pieces
- Saba Bananas or Plantain - 2 pieces (≈0.5 lb)
- Bean Sprouts - 1 × 454 g (1 lb) bag
- Spinach, fresh - 1 × 454 g (1 lb) bag
- Saba Bananas or Plantain - 2 pieces (≈0.5 lb)

Frozen Produce

- Edamame, frozen, shelled - 1 lb (454 g) bag

Dry Goods / Grains

- Short-Grain Brown Rice - 300 g
- Brown Rice - 100 g

Refrigerated / Noodles

- Shirataki Noodles - 2 × 200 g packs
- Shirataki Rice - 1 × 250 g pack or 1 pack

Produce - Fresh Herbs

- Fresh Cilantro - 1 bunch (≈30 g)
- Fresh Mint - 1 bunch (≈30 g)
- Fresh Basil (optional garnish) - 1 bunch (≈30 g)

International / Dried Produce

• Taro Leaves, dried - 200 g (1 package)

International / Sea Vegetables

• Nori Seaweed Sheets, roasted unsalted - 1 package (at least 4 full sheets)
• Dried Kelp Sheet (Kombu) - 1 small pack (at least 1 sheet, 5×5 cm)

Baking / Dry Goods

• Unsweetened Shredded Coconut - 100 g
• Almond Flour (Ultra-Fine) - 100 g
• Coconut Flour - 100 g
• Unflavored Plant Protein Powder (Pea or Soy Isolate) - 100 g

Baking / Seeds

• Black Sesame Seeds - 50 g
• Toasted Sesame Seeds - 50 g
• Pumpkin Seeds (Pepitas), roasted unsalted - 50 g
• Chia Seeds, black - 200 g

Canned Goods

• Canned Chickpeas (No-Salt-Added) - 2 × 425 g cans

International / Baking

• Coconut Wraps (Gluten-Free, Low-Carb) - 1 package (at least 4 wraps, 20×20 cm each)

International / Refrigerated

• Filipino Miso (Yellow/White, Low Sodium if available) - 100 g

Non-Dairy Milk

• Coconut Milk, Lite Unsweetened (Carton or Canned) - 2 l

Canned & Packaged Broth

• Vegetable Broth, Low-Sodium, Gluten-Free, Unsweetened - 3 l

Cooking Oil

- Avocado Oil - 400 ml
- Canola Oil (Cold-Pressed, Optional Swap for Avocado Oil) - 100 ml
- Toasted Sesame Oil - 100 ml

International / Sauces

- Low-Sodium Tamari (Gluten-Free) or Coconut Aminos - 400 ml
- Coconut Aminos - 100 ml
- Rice Vinegar (Unsweetened) - 200 ml
- Gochujang (Low Sodium, Gluten-Free, or Substitute) - 1 small tub (at least 100 g)

Spices

- Gochugaru (Korean Chili Flakes) or Red Pepper Flakes - 50 g
- Chinese Five-Spice Powder (Salt-Free) - 30 g
- Turmeric Powder - 30 g
- Black Pepper (Whole or Ground) - 50 g
- White Pepper (Ground) - 30 g
- Garlic Powder - 30 g
- Onion Powder - 30 g

Baking / Sweeteners

- Monk Fruit Sweetener (or Stevia, Granulated) - 100 g
- Erythritol (Powdered or Granulated) - 100 g

Baking / Flavourings

• Vanilla Extract (Alcohol-Free Preferred) - 50 ml

Baking / Thickeners

• Cornstarch or Arrowroot Starch - 50 g
• Glucomannan Powder or Xanthan Gum - 30 g

International / Cooking Wine

• Shaoxing Wine - 1 small bottle (375 ml)

Vinegar

• Apple Cider Vinegar - 250 ml

Snacks / Nuts

• Roasted Unsalted Peanuts (optional garnish) - 30 g